Contact

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Top Skills

Time Management
Project Supervision
PMP

Certifications

Project Management Foundations: Risk
Project Management Foundations: Requirements
Project Management Foundations: Teams
Project Management Foundations: Quality
Project Management Foundations: Ethics

James Ratliff, PMP

Program Manager
Russell, Kentucky, United States

Summary

As a Program Manager I lead and oversee complex projects that deliver innovative and effective solutions for the defense and commercial sector. With 6.5+ years of experience in this role and 12.5+ years of prior experience as an Operations Manager in the US Army, I have developed strong analytical, organizational, and communication skills that enable me to manage project teams, stakeholders, and resources efficiently and successfully.

My core competencies include operational planning and management, warehouse operations, risk management, and training. I am passionate about applying my military background and project management certification to improve the performance and quality of products and services. I am always eager to learn new skills and technologies that can enhance my expertise and help me achieve my professional goals.

Experience

Tyonek Native Corp
Program Manager
February 2025 - Present (1 year 5 months)

Bravura Information Technology Systems, Inc. (BITS)
Project Managemt Office Manager
December 2016 - February 2025 (8 years 3 months)
Aberdeen, Maryland

FRITO LAY
Manufacturing Warehouse Supply Chain Leader
August 2015 - December 2016 (1 year 5 months)
Aberdeen, MD

1st Cavalry Division
Senior Advisor & Operations Manager

October 2010 - August 2013 (2 years 11 months)

Served consecutive assignments as First Sergeant for a 178-member Combat Engineer Company and for a 242-member Headquarters & Headquarters Company within 1st Cavalry Division.
Held accountability for $80M – $196M in assets and equipment.
Seamlessly orchestrated deployed operations supporting Operation New Dawn (OND) across 3 locations covering 420-square miles in Iraq, including oversight of housing and life support for 178 personnel and allocation, tracking, and recovery of $150M in mission-critical equipment.
Tracked and managed 1,500+ operational patrols covering 50,000 miles throughout Iraq.
Developed risk management program and established operational safety standards, sustaining rate of zero safety incidents.
Conceptualized and developed operational training plans for 110 personnel on mission-critical procedures and techniques; facilitated training and professional crew certification for 48 teams / crews.
Propelled operational readiness by 50% through training and qualification for 250 staff with an aggressive 90-day schedule.
Operations & Project Manager, ’09 to ’10 – Aberdeen Proving Ground, Maryland: Led diverse operations and initiatives within Robotics Program Office of Army Research, Development, and Evaluation Command, holding responsibility for $8M in research facility and research and development (R&D) assets.
Served as senior advisor to Director, Vehicle Technology Directorate (VTD) and subject-matter expert (SME) in real-world requirements of autonomous ground robotic vehicle technologies.
Played instrumental role in Department of Defense (DoD) Black Box Work Group tasked with R&D of event recorder for tactical vehicles.
Hand selected to spearhead blast seat technology research toward reducing operational injuries.
Overhauled RFI process to decrease turnaround time for fielding of new technologies.

US Army

18 years 8 months

Operations Manager

January 2001 - August 2013 (12 years 8 months)

Advanced through progressively responsible, 20+-year leadership tenure, retiring as First Sergeant (1SG). Led diverse operations and ongoing team training and development in support of wide ranging and complex operations.

Tank Commander
January 1995 - January 2001 (6 years 1 month)

Completed the highly selective Master Gunner course.

1SG C 3BSTB/HHC 3-8 Cav
1SG
2010 - 2013 (3 years)

RDECOM
Operations
2009 - 2010 (1 year)

25th Infantry Division/ 172nd SBCT
Senior Advisor & Operations Manager
January 2004 - September 2009 (5 years 9 months)

’04 to ’09 – Fort Wainwright, Alaska: Held progressively responsible leadership roles as Assistant Operation Sergeant—managing $13M in land, ranges, and ammunition; as Platoon Sergeant—leading mobile gun system platoon of 12-22; and as First Sergeant—selected over 3 other qualified candidates to lead 167-member infantry company.
Held accountability for up to $18M in property, land, facilities, assets, equipment, and vehicles.
Led hundreds of patrols through Iraq and assisted in the clearance of over 10,000 buildings in Baghdad while deployed in support of Operation Iraqi Freedom (OIF) and Operation Together Forward; played integral role in providing security for Iraqi national elections and trained, coached, and mentored Iraqi military teams during joint operations.
Spearheaded development and delivery of leadership development program, enabling training and qualification of 75 junior leaders.
Sustained 100% readiness status for all equipment through effective preventive maintenance strategies and integration of risk management processes; held collateral role such as Safety Manager.
As Assistant Operations Sergeant, managed the largest training area in the US Army—4 training areas up to 400 miles apart within total area of 2,400 square miles—in support of training for 4,000 personnel in geographically separated locations.
Oversaw logistical planning and transportation operations to move $20M in equipment.

Columbus Recruiting BN

Recruiter

January 2001 - January 2004 (3 years 1 month)

Led recruiting initiatives to attract talent, interviewing and evaluating candidates in alignment with organizational capability needs.
Achieved top recruiter status and remained at #1 for 3 consecutive months, traveling 12K miles throughout the region.
Selected to serve as interim / acting Station Commander for 6 months, responsible for an area consisting of 10 high schools and 1 college, covering a total area of 457 square miles.
Earned consistent recognition for top performance throughout career, receiving array of honors, medals, and awards—including 3 Bronze Star Medals, 2 Meritorious Service Medals, 8 Army Commendation / Achievement Medals, and array of overseas / national defense service medals.

Education

Greenup County High School

· (1984 - 1988)